IV. Balanced Ecosystem

Imagine an environment where there are only plants, deer and lions.

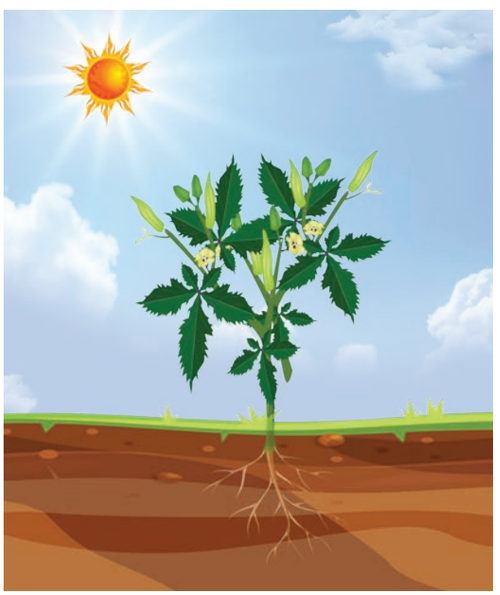
- What will happen to the deer if we remove all the lions?
- What will happen to the plants if there are no lions to eat the deer?
- If all the plants are eaten, what will happen to the deer?

It is important for the food chain to exist in any ecosystem to make sure that the energy flows between the biotic and abiotic factors. A balanced ecosystem supports animals, plants and microorganisms to grow in their environment. **An ecosystem is balanced, when the biotic and abiotic factors are able to cycle the energy and food as per their need.**

The biotic factors in an ecosystem includes **producers, consumers and decomposers.**

1. Producers

The living things that can prepare their own food are called producers. **Green plants** are the **producers**. They make their own food by the process of **photosynthesis**. Hence, they are called **primary producers.** Humans and animals depend on plants for their food.





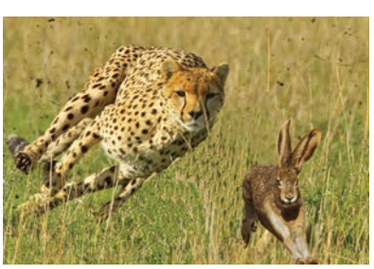
More to know

A few plants **do not produce their food** and they depend on other plants. They are called **parasitic plants.** E.g., **Cuscuta**

2. Consumers

The **living things that eat the food prepared by the producers** are called **consumers**. Most of the living things depend directly or indirectly on producers for their food. Consumers can be divided into **three types** based on their food as **herbivores** (plant eating animal), **carnivores** (flesh eating animal), **omnivores** (both plant and flesh eating animal).







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